

Chan Meng

A minimalist. **Subtraction for life, addition for thought.**

This isn't a résumé. It's a short field guide to how I think and what I make — written for anyone curious about my products and the way I work.

If you're here to hire, my two-page CV is one click away: chanmeng.org/cv.



Arms up, out on the water — the spirit I'd like this read in.

CHAPTER 1

My Story

I started with maps, taught maths, watched an industry vanish, and at thirty crossed the world to begin again.

My degree was in geography; my first real job was teaching maths to teenagers in China. Then, almost overnight, the private-tutoring industry I worked in was regulated out of existence. At thirty — the age everyone says is too late — I moved to a place where I could breathe freely and rebuild, and read for a Master of Applied Computing at Lincoln University, finishing with **Distinction**.

I never learned to code the old way. From my first assignment I built alongside AI, pairing with a model the way other students paired with a lab partner. That wasn't a shortcut — it's the origin of how I work now: someone who **directs** coding agents rather than typing every line.

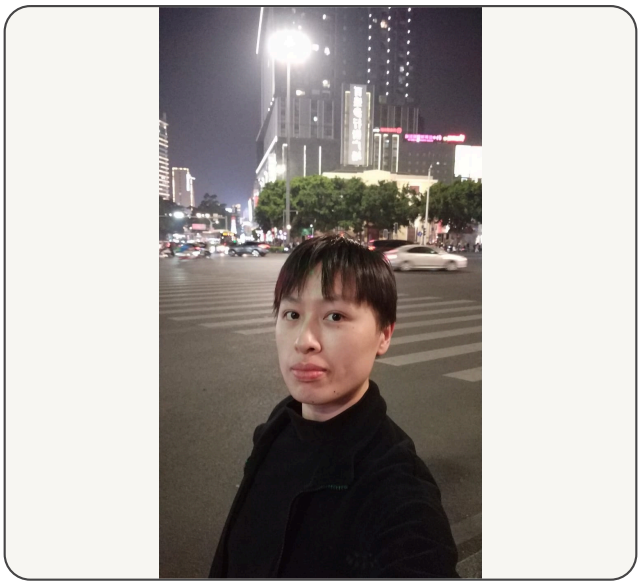
The proof came from an unexpected place. An early-stage founder asked his own Claude agent to find him an engineer. It read the open web and recommended me — which the founder, Engram's Luka Madzarac, later confirmed in public. I hadn't applied. The work had. Auckland, for its part, met me with more kindness than I expected.



On a She Sharp panel in Auckland — the community that took me in.



Lincoln University, Canterbury — November 2023, my first weeks in the programme.



Before: a night street in Nanning, Guangxi — my hometown, where I grew up.



After: on site at CORDE in Canterbury — the infrastructure firm my Lincoln industry placement shipped into, 2024.

> When execution gets cheap, the work that matters is choosing what to build — and having the taste to keep only what's worth keeping.

CHAPTER 2

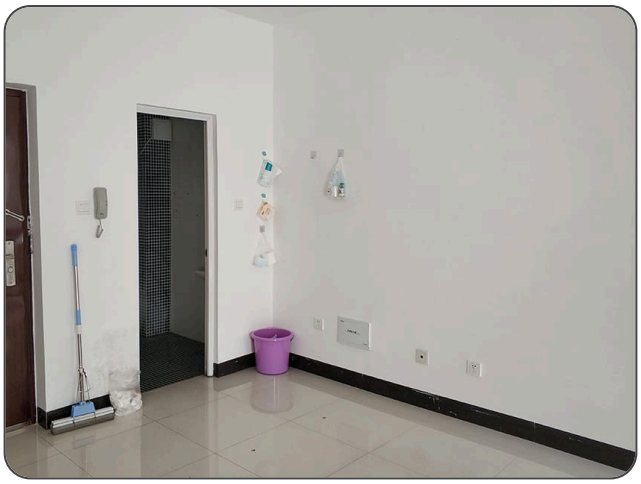
A Minimalist

Subtraction as a daily practice — and, it turns out, as an engineering philosophy.

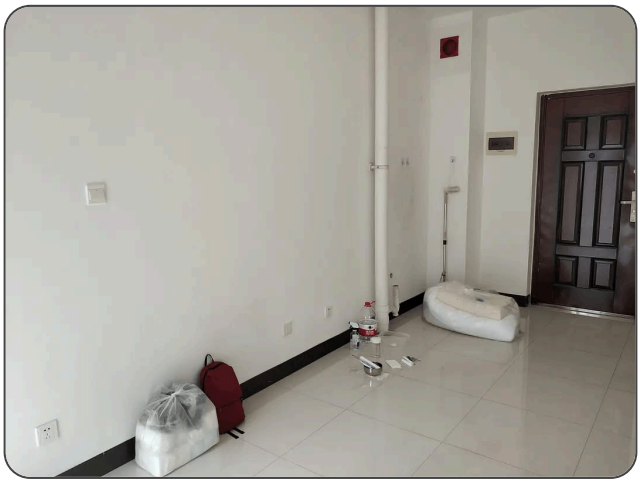
It began with a broken charging cable and a bent hairpin. I threw them out, felt lighter, and kept going. Today everything I own fits into one backpack and one suitcase. I don't keep a living room — I borrow the city's.



One room, almost empty.



Front door, bathroom, bare walls — the room corner to corner.



Everything I own, packed — one backpack and one bundle.



A mattress on the floor, the city out the window.

People read along. A few pieces travelled far:

Girl on Mattress

100k+ reads · 3,864 reshares

mp.weixin.qq.com/s/hRh8rTF9gjdpI8KEixuSFQ

A Glimpse of My Minimalist Home

100k+ reads · 14k reshares

mp.weixin.qq.com/s/eZx_Mo5F6BRfVNVceQCS8Q



I Threw Away My Old Name

29k+ reads

chanmeng.org/blog/threw-away-my-old-name

At thirty I legally changed my name and remade who I am. I wrote about it on the blog.

It's the same instinct in my software: **stripping away what isn't needed so the essential works better** — whether that's a living space or a system. It shows up as calm dashboards, as anti-bloat discipline (my CopilotKit contribution cut a flow from eight paths down to three), and as npx chan-meng — a whole introduction in one command.



Nothing on the floor that doesn't earn its place — the same rule I bring to a codebase.

> Living alone, I finally learned to confirm my own existence through my own eyes — my own perspective, my own taste.

CHAPTER 3

What I Build

The largest chapter — because the work is the argument. Ten systems: six products of my own and four I built for organisations. Every name is a link you can open.

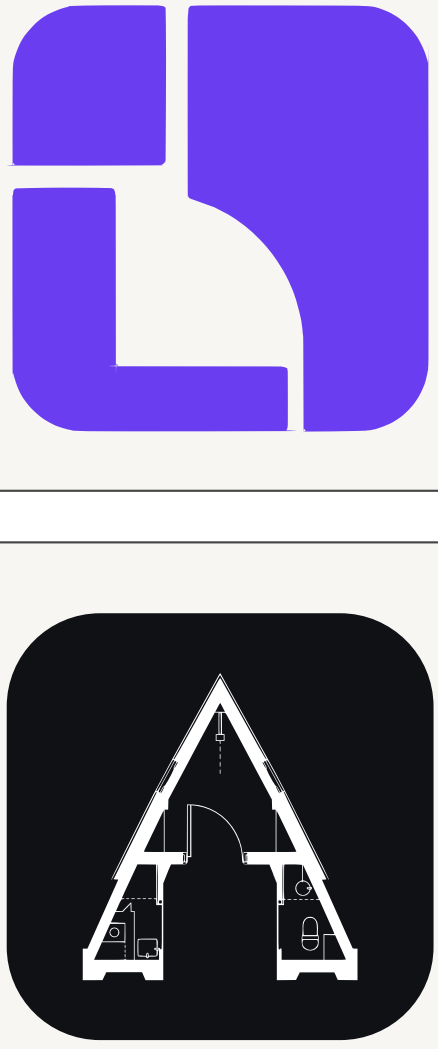
Two kinds of work, told apart by a violet line: the products I keep coming back to, and systems I built for the organisations that trusted me with theirs (Chapter 4 covers what I make beyond code). Same taste in both — precise artifacts over pretty pictures, tools you operate in plain language, and systems small enough to hold in your head.

ArchCanvas

An AI design agent for architects and self-builders: describe a building and it draws a dimensioned floor plan you can actually build from, plus a realistic rendering.

Refine it by talking, on an infinite zoomable canvas; every plan is real ArchLang underneath, exportable as a full git history.

archcanvas.uk



ArchLang

A small language for floor plans: write walls and rooms in plain text, get back a precise dimensioned drawing, change one number and exactly one thing moves.

A zero-dependency TypeScript compiler exporting SVG, DXF, PDF, and PNG — and it checks whether a plan is actually livable. The engine behind ArchCanvas.

archlang.uk

GAVIGO IRE

For GAVIGO Inc. — Founding Principal Engineer

The “Instant Reality Exchange”: a platform that keeps the next game in a phone feed on standby and activates it as you arrive, built as the founding engineering effort behind a start-up.

Go and Kubernetes orchestration: in controlled proof-stage tests, 78% less application-level startup work and a startup path cut from 4.45 s to 1.00 s; moved from DigitalOcean to Google Cloud in a 30-minute cutover.

ire.gavigo.com gavigo.com

She Sharp member platform

For She Sharp — Senior Full Stack Engineer & Website Team Lead

Moved a volunteer-run New Zealand women-in-STEM charity off Webflow and spreadsheets onto a platform it owns: AI mentor matching with human review, Stripe memberships, and a dashboard each for mentors, mentees, and admins.

Next.js, Drizzle, and Neon Postgres: 84 API routes and 63 pages, plus Slack automations that turn event publishing into a one-command change.

shesharp.org.nz

FemTech Weekend website

For FemTech Weekend — Chief Technology Officer

The home of China's first women's-health-technology organisation, which carried its Shanghai Summit 2026: summit application forms, an admin dashboard with review and approval emails, and a bilingual English / 简体中文 site.

Docusaurus on Cloudflare Pages with Drizzle and Neon Postgres; 16 serverless endpoints handle the whole server side.

femtechweekend.com

Eatropolis festival website

For Chow Luck Club — commission, reviewed by Tātaki Auckland Unlimited

The official site for Auckland's one-day culinary festival with 30+ award-winning chefs: a two-phase public reveal, and a content workflow the non-technical team edits straight from the browser.

Next.js 16 on Cloudflare Workers, built to a 1,000-concurrent-visitor load-test target and to the NZ Government Web Accessibility Standard (WCAG 2.2 AA).

eatropolis.co.nz



echook

An audio-and-status plugin for Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex — you never learn it; you just tell your AI agent "install echook" or "snooze for 30 minutes."

Pure Python standard library, 39 hook events and a context-window status bar, tested on Windows, macOS, and Linux. Open source under MIT.

github.com/ChanMeng666/echook

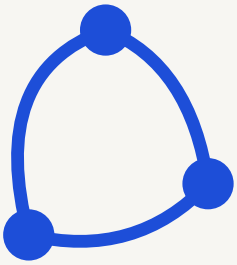


Google News MCP Server

One of the earliest servers for the Model Context Protocol — the open standard Anthropic launched in late 2024 — and this one shipped just five weeks later.

It lets Claude, Cursor, and Cline search live Google News by topic in ten languages; published on npm and carried across 15+ MCP catalogs, a PulseMCP "Top Pick."

github.com/ChanMeng666/server-google-news



a11y-loop

Makes AI coding agents write accessible interfaces by default, checks them in a real browser, and says plainly what it could not check.

A Claude Code skill and an npm CLI running Playwright and axe-core 4.12 against WCAG 2.2 AA. Open source under MIT.

github.com/ChanMeng666/a11y-loop



AI Programming Education Platform

A public site where beginners learn to build software with AI, with three years of cohorts kept side by side and an in-site AI tutor that answers from each class's own lessons.

Docusaurus in English and 简体中文, with a retrieval-based tutor on Cloudflare Workers; five course versions online, three of them running in 2026.

programming.chanmeng.org

> Precise artifacts over pretty pictures. Every one of these you can open and try — that's the whole argument.

CHAPTER 4

What I Make Beyond Code

Software is half of what an organisation needs from me. The other half is what it shows the world.

I typeset reports in code, cut promo films in code, and build the decks, slides and newsletters an organisation runs on — then make the record findable by the AI models people now ask instead of a search box. Everything on these four pages shipped for a real organisation; all of it is on chanmeng.org/work.

TYPESET PDF REPORTS

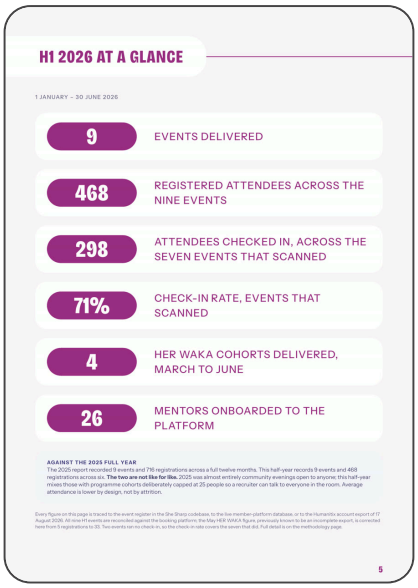
She Sharp 2026 Half-Year Report

A 31-page funder report for a New Zealand women-in-STEM charity, typeset in Typst from the charity's own records — with a build gate that refuses to ship a figure not traced to a source.

31 pages · Typst + CeTZ charts · every figure source-traced

Download the PDF





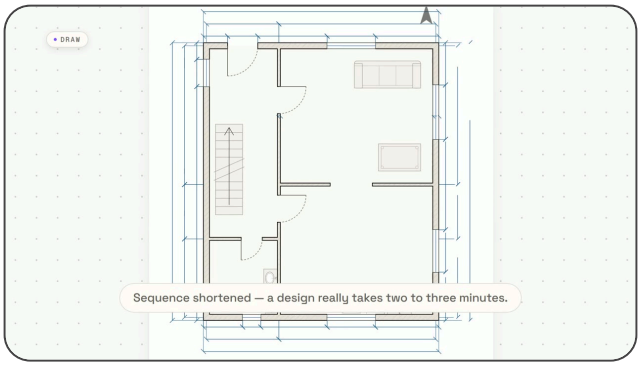


Cover · H1 at a glance · a chapter opener

PROMO FILMS

Two films, built as code in Remotion

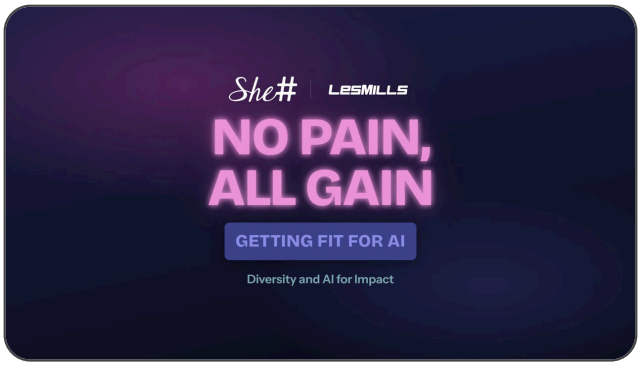
Neither is a screen recording: every frame is rendered from code, scored with Suno and cut on the beat, in every aspect ratio a channel needs.



ArchCanvas studio film

A coded replica of the product · 15 / 30 / 60 / 120 s · 16:9 + 9:16

Watch on YouTube



She Sharp × Les Mills — “No Pain, All Gain”

A 30 s event promo from event photographs · 4 aspect ratios

Watch on LinkedIn

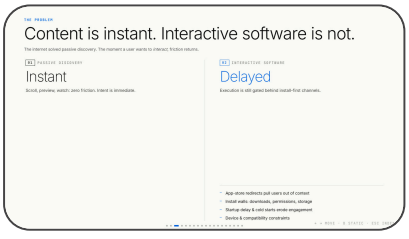
PITCH DECKS

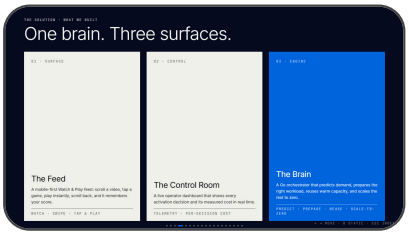
GAVIGO technical proof deck

A 19-slide investor deck in a Swiss international-style grid, built as a single HTML file for the founder to present live and send.

19 slides · single-file HTML · Swiss grid







Cover · problem · solution — the only slides shown; the deck itself stays private

EVENT SLIDES

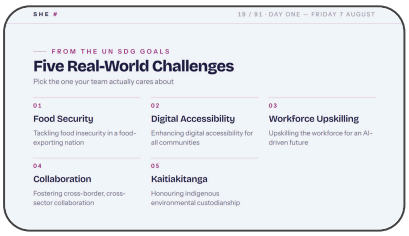
Aotearoa AI Hackathon Festival 2026

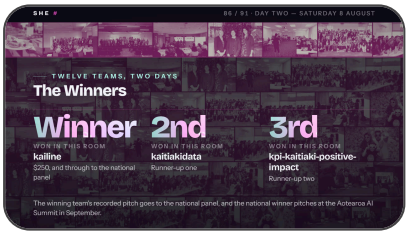
The 91-slide deck that ran two days of She Sharp's hackathon at AUT, rendered in the browser from the event's own data — timers, team slides and the winners reveal included.

91 slides · 2 days · 12 teams

Open the deck live







Cover · the challenges · the winners reveal

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

From rented software to a system the charity owns

She Sharp's website, mailing list and records moved off Webflow, Mailchimp, Humanitix and Slack onto infrastructure it owns — written up as a record where every number is tagged measured, cited or derived.

13.3
months to move the website and mailing list onto owned infrastructure

1,549
people on the mailing list cut over, with 0 failures

1.15 GB
of the charity's own operating record recovered from four platforms

179
past newsletters recovered and served from its own site

11
recurring jobs written down as agent skills a non-engineer can follow

2,129
non-consenting contacts held as one-way hashes, so no import brings them back

Headline figures only; the full record stays with the charity.

NEWSLETTERS

Two newsletters, on owned infrastructure

Chan's AI Weekly, a five-minute briefing written with Claude Code and sent through Resend; and She Sharp's monthly, moved off Mailchimp with a 1,549-person cutover and 0 failures.

chanmeng.org/newsletter shesharp.org.nz/resources/newsletters



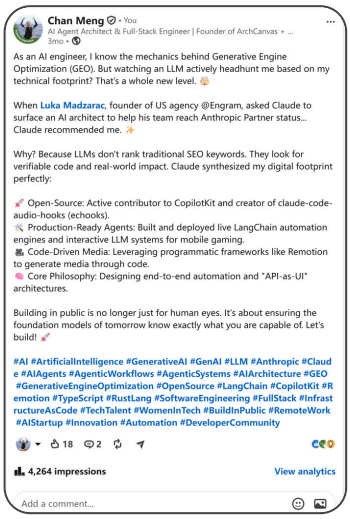
Chan's AI Weekly, the top of one issue and the inside of another · The Monthly She#, the same

SEO & GEO

Surfaced by Claude, confirmed by the founder

When Engram's founder asked Claude Code to find an AI architect, it surfaced me. The public footprint it read — llms.txt, JSON-LD and an open-source record, all generated from one data source — is built for exactly that reader.

4,264 impressions · llms.txt + JSON-LD · geo-markdown-mirror skill



> "It's true, Claude Code surfaced Chan as one of the strongest matches for what we're looking for."



Luka Madzarac

Founder, Engram · the post

CHAPTER 5

Teaching

Three years, five cohorts. My whole method in one line.

“Natural language is the source code.”

Students arrive knowing only browser ChatGPT. Weeks later they have shipped a live, multi-user AI product by directing coding agents — the same way I work. I have run this five times since 2024, most recently for TechNest and at a hands-on workshop where a banana piano taught younger students that code can be playful. They range from twelve-year-olds at that workshop, through high-school students I mentored at an AI hackathon, to adults retraining for a new career — the method holds; only the pace changes.



AI Hackathon Festival 2025 at AUT — walking Westlake Girls High School students through AI coding tools.



A She Sharp workshop for teens — a browser game on the laptop, the room crowded in.

“Chan’s teaching style is meticulous and thorough, with patient and in-depth explanations for the use of each tool.” — Jessie Wan, course student.

CHAPTER 6

Voices

Twenty-seven people who've worked with me — every one of them, in their own words.



Kwame



Suliat



Abiodun



Ikenna



Swayam



Mahdieh



Shivani



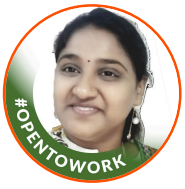
Prasanth



Lesley



Saba



Nirmala



Yesha



Siyu



Cecilia



Amy



Paige



Gabby



Chaste



Mi Su



Shushu



Patricia



Robin



Shiyu



Jessie



Di



Qiao Jun



Daryll

> … she often goes out of her way to build things that genuinely help others learn … To me, that is what true empowerment looks like.



— Lesley Gao · She Sharp website team

> … what I witnessed at the hackathon was something that doesn't show up on a resume: her instinct to mentor … she's the kind of person who genuinely raises the bar for everyone around her.



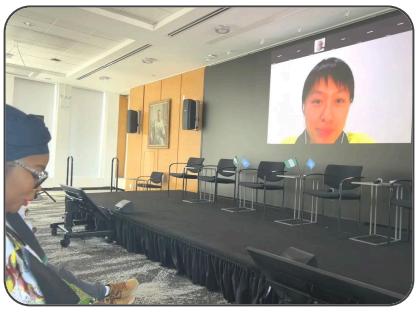
— Shivani Dhandabani · AI hackathon

All 27 recommendations; the live ones in full: linkedin.com/in/chanmeng666.

CHAPTER 7

Recognition

Where the work has been seen.



UN CSW69, New York, March 2025.



2025 festival keynote, Auckland.



MC'ing the 2026 opening.

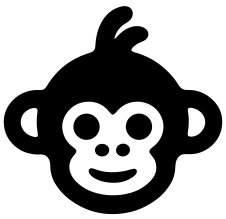


Meet the Mentors — the 2026 festival cohort, AUT.



Mentoring a team at their table, August 2026.

- **UN CSW69 Speaker** — UN HQ, New York, March 2025 · drew IBM pilot interest and an endorsement from Sierra Leone's Minister of Gender and Children's Affairs.
- **Outstanding Mentor Award, two years running** — AI Hackathon Festival 2025 (1 of 14 expert mentors, 11 teams / 80+ participants) and Aotearoa AI Hackathon Festival 2026 (125 registered participants, twelve teams), where I also MC'd the opening.
- **a11y-loop, being adopted by My Life My Voice** — the disability-led NZ organisation that set the accessible-UI challenge at the 2026 festival is taking up the open-source tool I built for it, for its own development team.
- **UN Women FemTech Hackathon — Outstanding Performer** — FemTech Weekend, Beijing, March 2025.
- **Excellence Award** — FemTech China, Women's Health Technology Challenge, December 2024.



Where to find me

- chanmeng.org
- chanmeng.org/blog
- Newsletter
- linkedin.com/in/chanmeng666
- github.com/ChanMeng666
- youtube.com/@ChanMeng666
- cal.com/chan-meng/30min